Sex Roles in Education
C EP 320 M01
Spring 2020
"To understand and to be understood is to be free." –Daniel Johnston

Instructor: Brett Opelt, M.S., LPC
Email: blopelt@nmsu.edu (I will return your message within 24 hours M-F)

Office Location: Through Zoom or Google Hangouts
Office Hours: By virtual appointment only
Class days and hours: Tuesdays and Thursdays, 11:45 A.M.-1:00 P.M. *through synchronous classroom environment (aka Zoom).*

COURSE DESCRIPTION

This course will address theory, research, and commentary related to gender. Gender issues that will be covered include:

1. Gender role socialization
2. Issues related to learning and education
3. Gender stereotypes
4. The influence of media
5. Gender in the work environment
6. Differences in emotional expression
7. Differences in relationships
8. And issues of diversity in educational settings.

Biological and social aspects of gender, as well as sexual differences, will be a prominent theme and will be explored and discussed throughout the course. Additionally, we will discuss the intersection of multiple identities (e.g., gender, ethnicity, age, religious affiliation, sexual orientation, social class) and how our experiences, values, beliefs, and opinions impact others and the world around us.

This class will be highly discussion oriented and may include adult themes of sexuality and current diversity issues. Please see the professor if this is going to be a problem for you.

REQUIRED TEXTBOOK

Wood, J.T. & Fixmer-Oraiz, N. (2019). *Gender Lives: Communication, Gender, & Culture* (13th ed.). ISBN: 978-1-337-55588-3

*Other relevant materials and supplemental readings will be posted to Canvas as they are needed

OBJECTIVES

- Increase awareness of gender issues and how gender issues intersect with other identities.

- Increase knowledge about feminism and masculinity from a multicultural and systems perspective.
- Increase knowledge about gender issues among people of color, geographic regions, and differing socioeconomic status.
- Gain an understanding of intentional and unintentional sexist behavior and the consequences of such behavior.
- Prepare students to work with diverse populations by emphasizing differences in values based on gender roles.
- Practice interpersonal and team-building skills.
- Practice critical thinking skills in evaluating research evidence.
- Increase knowledge of how gender influences education.
- Understanding systemic influences on gender issues and learning how to take action for social justice.

TOOLS FOR INSTRUCTION

This course will use the NMSU Canvas system located at http://learn.nmsu.edu. All papers and similar written assignments should be submitted using this system. If you have technical difficulties with submitting your papers using Canvas, you may e-mail me your paper at blopelt@nmsu.edu in order to avoid a late penalty.

If you are having problems with Canvas, you might try downloading and using a different Web browser instead. Two excellent free browsers are:

Firefox: http://www.firefox.com (as of this writing, current version is 40.0 or above)
Chrome: http://www.chrome.com (as of this writing, current version is 42.0 or above)
Be sure to keep your browsers updated to the latest versions!

Canvas is also now available for download as a free app on iOS and Android systems.

**It is the student's responsibility to regularly check emails and Canvas for updates regarding the class.*

***UPDATE**: This course will now take place through Zoom in order to maintain a synchronous learning environment for students. The instructor will send Zoom meeting times, which will be scheduled for the regularly scheduled course time, for students to access Zoom and participate in class. Classes will be recorded for students who are unable to access the immediate class time or for students who would like to play back the lecture, in order to create fairness in access for everyone.*

EVALUATION PROCEDURES
The following procedures will be used to evaluate course members' mastery of course objectives.

APA Format Quiz (15 points): This quiz will be taken online during the second week of the semester. You will have an infinite amount of time and number of attempts on the quiz and are therefore encouraged to take the quiz until they make a perfect score. It covers questions related to APA formatting and citation, as all your assignments in this course are written. **The quiz is due at 11:59 pm on January 28th, 2020.**

Discussion Post (10 Points): There will be 1 discussion post due to instructor being out of town. Students will post about their knowledge of gender, messages that they are aware of receiving regarding their gender and understanding of differences between gender and biological sex. This discussion will solely focus on the introduction PowerPoint (that is only 3 slides) and to get a foundational understanding of where students are coming from in their understanding of the role of gender and biological sex in students' daily lives. **The discussion is due at 11:59 pm on January 28th, 2020.**

WRITTEN ASSIGNMENTS

All written assignments should be uploaded to Canvas in the area for the assignment. **No hard copies will be accepted. All papers at minimum must include the following APA formatting: double spaced, in 12-point Times Roman font, with 1" margins**. Page numbers should also be 12-point Times Roman and in the upper right on all pages.

All written assignments are due at 11:59 pm Thursday. Please keep this in mind.

Introduction Paper (15 points): For the first assignment, I would like you to answer the question "How has my gender impacted my life?" This is an open-ended question designed to get you thinking about living in a gendered world. There are no right or wrong answers. Your perception of the prominent ways gender has shaped your life and made you who you are is an important idea to reflect upon. This paper should be approximately 2 to 2.5 pages long.

If you prefer a follow a more formal structure to this paper, I suggest thinking about how your gender has affected your other social identities (e.g., age, ethnicity, religious affiliation, social economic status, sexual orientation, etc.). Please do not feel that you must limit yourself to this list.

End this paper by stating what your expectations are for this course. What would you like to learn? How do you think a class like this might be helpful in everyday life? **Due at 11:59 pm on Thursday, February 6th**.

Reflection Papers (three papers, 20 points each): Over the course of the semester you will complete three reaction papers discussing the material covered in class. The expected length is 2 to 3 pages (no more) per reaction paper. Each paper must focus on the course material (gender) in some manner. This can be accomplished in a variety of ways:

- Provide reactions to text content and/or the process and outcome of class exercises
- Offer personal reflections on gender in different relationships and/or settings (e.g., family, home, work, school)
- Offer descriptions of experiences that relate in some way to class discussions or exercises

Some students may be concerned about others reading their paper. Only the instructor of the course will have access to read the material and it will not be shared with other students. If there are concerns regarding any disclosures, please talk with your instructor.

Reaction papers are due at 11:59 pm on Thursdays (February 20th, March 12th, and April 16th)

Research Essay (50 points total): Each student will write a research essay on a different theory of gender study and how it is applied to modern academics and study of gendered lives. The essay should include at least 3 academic resources and includes the student's own thoughts and opinions on how to apply the theory

to the world around them. The assignment is a way to practicing academic research and thinking critically about the world around them.

This 4 to 6-page paper should consist of two general parts: *a)* the summary of the articles (describing the participants, methods, and general results of the study), and *b)* your own discussion of the paper as described in the following questions:

1. Why did you choose this theory?
2. How is the research relevant or important? What are the implications of the results?
3. What are the limitations of this theory?
4. What did you find most interesting about this theory?
5. Does it support your pre-existing beliefs or challenge them?

Answer the questions in a narrative format (do not list them and answer them; rather integrate them into the flow of the paper).

This paper should use full APA style with citations (**with no Abstract page**). All sources should be cited and listed on your References page. Please see http://owl.english.purdue.edu/owl/resource/560/01/or the actual APA Style Manual for help with APA formatting. This paper is due **at 11:59pm, Thursday, March 19th.**

Personal Narrative Final Paper (100 points): One key component of this course involves encouraging students to make connections between personal, subjective experience and theoretical perspectives. To facilitate making these connections, you are asked to reflect critically on your own educational experiences within the context of some aspect of theories and perspectives shared in class. Write a personal narrative on some facet of your educational experience and interpret your story with the assistance of a theoretical perspective introduced in our class or discovered through your own research. (Make sure to carefully document your sources.) In other words, identify a specific perspective addressed in class or the textbook and use it to interpret some facet of your own educational experience.

For the assignment, you may want to consider the following when deciding on what aspect of your education to focus on (this list is not to be considered exhaustive):

- Athletics
- Behavioral issues
- Teachers
- Major and/or career selection
- Areas of privilege in your education, as well as areas where you have experienced disadvantage
- Intersection of other aspects of your identity with your gender, and how that impacted your education
- Peer relations at different ages

In writing this narrative, focus on themes throughout your educational experience (e.g., your experience with athletics in elementary, middle, and high school and college) or incidents (e.g., the reaction others had to your selection of major). Remember, you are not only sharing the facts of what happened, you are now reinterpreting the experience through course material and theories presented.

Given that this is a narrative essay, some students may be concerned about others reading their paper. Only the instructor of the course will have access to read the material and it will not be shared with other students. If there are concerns regarding any disclosures, please talk with your instructor. This paper is due at **11:59pm, Thursday, May 5th.** The expected length is 5-7 pages.

GROUP PROJECT (previously Group Presentation): Your team will choose a topic to present that is related to sex roles in education. All topics must be approved by the instructor. The presentation will be no more than 20 slides. ***Students are encouraged to utilize Google Drive, Google Hangouts, Zoom, FaceTime, Skype, or any other online platform to work with group members virtually in completing this project. There will no longer be a presentation component, but the assignment will still be submitted for grading on Canvas.*** Out of a total of 40 points, a maximum of 30 points will be given based on the evaluation of the presentation (the same grade given to all members), and 10 points will be awarded for being *an active participant in the creation of the group project.* **Group project is due at 11:59pm, Thursday, May 14th.**

Late work: While it is expected that assignments will be submitted by the due date, ***I will allow for 1 assignment to be late without penalty or any form of documentation as to why it is late. It needs to be submitted within 1 week of the original due date. The instructor needs to be contact and informed 24 hours before the assignment is due for this policy.*** **This policy DOES NOT apply to your final paper or group project.** Both of these assignments are due at the end of the semester and I am required to have final grades in shortly after the last day of class. I will not be able to accept these assignments to be late. If an assignment is turned in after this time or after you have used your 1 excused assignment, it will be considered late and will not be accepted without documentation. Because technical difficulties occur often, students can submit their paper 15 minutes after the deadline without penalty.

Extra Credit **(**There will be 3 extra credit opportunities offered)

1) You may attend counseling sessions at the Counseling & Educational Psychology Clinic in O'Donnell Hall Rm. 047 for a total of 8 session to receive 10% extra credit of total points in the course (i.e. 10% of 235 total points=23.5 extra credit points).
2) You may also attend any workshop/discussions on campus and will receive 10 points for each workshop/discussion that you attend, up to 10% of total points assigned in the course. You will be required to write a 1-page (minimum 250 words) reflection about what you took away from the workshop/discussion, and how it applies to developing relationships, as well as how it influences the way you communicate with others.
3) You may also participate in research studies and receive 5 points for each research study that you participate in, up to 10% of the total assigned points for the course. You will be required to submit a debriefing form that is provided by the research team.

THE SUCCESSFUL UNIVERSITY STUDENT

The faculty subscribes to the belief that if you as a course member commit to the following behaviors, you will promote your own growth and behavior and optimize your opportunity for success not only in this course, but also throughout your education at New Mexico State University. Research and professional observation have found the following behaviors to be primary contributors to becoming "The Successful University Student."

(1) Punctuality
You are expected to arrive for class and scheduled meetings with faculty on time. If you are unable to be on time for class, you are expected to make arrangements with a fellow course member to get notes from the missed class. You will also accept the consequences of not being allowed to take the quiz scheduled at that class.

(2) Communication
If any issues arise regarding missing class time, absences, or difficulties experienced in class, it is expected that you will contact the instructor to provide information or set up a time to meet and discuss the situation.

(3) Preparation
You are expected to be prepared for each quiz and assignment by having the materials required for each, otherwise, it is expected that you will accept the consequences of missing the opportunity to earn points for that quiz or other class project.

(4) Self-Initiative
You are expected to keep track of your own grades throughout the semester, otherwise you are expected to accept the consequences of not knowing your standing in the course prior to receiving your final course grade.

(5) Team Work
You are expected to work well as a team member in completing your group assignments. Applying the above principles of punctuality, communication, preparation, self-initiative, and active participation will contribute to your growth and development, and thus success, as a team member.

Academic Misconduct

Academic and non-academic misconduct: The Student Code of Conduct defines academic misconduct, non-academic misconduct and the consequences or penalties for each. The Student Code of Conduct is available in the NMSU Student Handbook online:

- **http://studenthandbook.nmsu.edu/**

Academic misconduct is explained here:

- **http://studenthandbook.nmsu.edu/student-code-of-conduct/academic-misconduct/**

Discrimination and Disability Accommodation

Section 504 of the Rehabilitation Act of 1973 and the Americans with Disabilities Act Amendments Act (ADA) covers issues relating to disability and accommodations. If a student has questions or needs an accommodation in the classroom (all medical information is treated confidentially), contact:

Main Campus
Student Accessibility Services (SAS)
Corbett Center Student Union Room 208
Trudy Luken, Director

575-646-6840
sas@nmsu.edu

New Mexico State University, in compliance with applicable laws and in furtherance of its commitment to fostering an environment that welcomes and embraces diversity, does not discriminate on the basis of age, ancestry, color, disability, gender identity, genetic information, national origin, race, religion, retaliation, serious medical condition, sex (including pregnancy), sexual orientation, spousal affiliation, or protected veteran status in its programs and activities, including employment, admissions, and educational programs and activities. Inquiries may be directed to the Laura Castille, Executive Director, Title IX and Section 504 Coordinator, Office of Institutional Equity, P.O. Box 30001, E. 1130 University Avenue, Las Cruces, NM 88003; 575.646.3635; 575-646-7802 (TTY); equity@nmsu.edu.

Title IX prohibits sex harassment, sexual assault, intimate partner violence, stalking and retaliation. For more information on discrimination or Title IX, or to file a complaint contact:

Laura Castille, Executive Director and Title IX Coordinator
Office of Institutional Equity (OIE) - O'Loughlin House, 1130 University Avenue
Phone: (575) 646-3635 E-mail: equity@nmsu.edu
Website: http://equity.nmsu.edu/

Other NMSU Resources:

NMSU Police Department:	(575) 646-3311	www.nmsupolice.com
NMSU Police Victim Services:	(575) 646-3424	
NMSU Counseling Center:	(575) 646-2731	
NMSU Dean of Students:	(575) 646-1722	
For Any On-campus Emergencies:	911	

College of Education
Conceptual Framework Theme: PREPARED

The Unit's conceptual framework provides an underlying structure, giving conceptual meaning to its operations though an articulated rationale. The conceptual framework provides direction for programs, courses, teaching, candidate performance, faculty scholarship and service, and unit accountability (adapted from *Professional Standards for the Accreditation of Teacher Preparation Institutions*, NCATE: 2008).

The NMSU College of Education has adopted PREPARED as its Conceptual Framework Theme. The elements of PREPARED, described below, provide the foundation for goals and outcomes for candidates, proficiencies, and ways in which these proficiencies are demonstrated.

Practitioners, Clinicians and Leaders

The Unit's commitment extends beyond preparing candidates to teach or continuing the professional development of practicing teachers; for, the Unit also prepares principals, school psychologists, counselors, mental health professionals, speech language pathologists, and physical education specialists for a broad range of professional roles in education.

Reflection

This is the process by which candidates are provided opportunities to be meta-cognitive and engage in thoughtful questioning and problems-based learning.

Effectiveness

This refers to the content, pedagogical and professional knowledge, skills and dispositions that candidates utilize to ensure that all students learn. Assessment of candidate effectiveness is performance-based, uses multiple measures, and is authentic. The preparation of effective practitioners addresses the mandates of *No Child Left Behind* and the demand for "highly qualified" and "effective" professionals.

Pedagogy

The Unit's and the candidate's educational and clinical practices are grounded in the general concepts, theories and research pertaining to effective teaching.

Assessment

This encompasses the formal and informal procedures for eliciting evidence related to Unit effectiveness, and both candidate and student learning. The Unit's assessment system is based on professional, state and institutional standards. It includes measures that are systematically used to collect data at predetermined transitional points in order to predict candidate success and improve programs. Candidates also gain expertise in the principles of classroom assessment.

Research

Theories, investigations, and policies drive the work of the Unit and undergird candidate preparation and practice.

Evaluation

This is the continuous process for determining the Unit's realization of its stated Mission, Goals and Outcomes. Both the Unit and candidates use rubrics to evaluate their effectiveness.

Diversity

Candidates, faculty, and students represent differences in gender, ethnicity, race, socio-economic status, language, religion, sexual identity, regional culture, and ability-level. The Unit provides opportunities for candidates to work with diverse students and to demonstrate dispositions that value fairness and the belief that all students can learn.

Distribution of Points

Assignment	**Points**
APA Format Quiz	15
Reflection Papers (3 at 20 points)	60
Introduction Paper	15
Research Essay	50
Personal Narrative Final Paper	100
Group Presentation	40
Participation/Discussion Post (1 at 10 points)	50
Total Possible	330

Grading Scale (% of points earned):

A = 95-100 B- = 80-82.9 D+ = 67-69.9
A- = 90-94.9 C+ = 77-79.9. D = 63-66.9
B+ = 87-89.9 C = 73-76.9 D- = 60-62.9
B = 83-86.9 C- = 70-72.9 F = 0-59.9

TENTATIVE COURSE OUTLINE

NOTE: The instructor reserves the right to make announced syllabus changes to enhance your learning experience.

Date	Topic	Required Reading	Assignments Due
1/23/20	**Course Introductions** Review of Syllabus	Read Syllabus	
1/28/20	**NO CLASS—Instructor out of town**	Review the Introduction PowerPoint Slide	APA-Format Quiz (Available on Canvas)
1/30/20	**Study of Communication, Gender, and Culture**	Chapter 1: Study of Communication, Gender, and Culture	
2/4/20	**Study of Communication, Gender, and Culture (Cont')**		
2/6/20	**Theory and Gender**	Chapter 2: Theoretical Approaches to Gender	Introduction Paper
2/11/20	**Theory and Gender (Cont')**		
2/13/20	**Rhetorical Shaping of Gender**	Chapter 3: The Rhetorical Shaping of Gender: Images of	

		Women (Beginning through 2nd Wave)	
2/18/20	**Rhetorical Shaping of Gender (Cont')**	Chapter 3 (Cont'): Contemporary Feminism through end of the chapter	
2/20/20	**Rhetorical Shaping of Gender (Cont')**	Chapter 4: The Rhetorical Shaping of Gender: Competing Images of Men (Beginning through Contemporary Men's Movements)	Reflection Journal 1
2/25/20	**Rhetorical Shaping of Gender (Cont')**	Chapter 4 (Cont'): Contemporary Men's Movements through the end of the chapter	
2/27/20	**Gender Socialization**	Chapter 7: Becoming Gendered	
3/3/20	**Gender Socialization (Cont')**	Chapter 7 (Cont'): Becoming Gendered	
3/5/20	**Communication**	Chapter 5: Gendered Verbal Communication	
3/10/20	**Communication (Cont')**	Chapter 5 (Cont'): Gendered Verbal Communication	
3/12/20	**Communication (Cont')**	Chapter 5 (Cont'): Gendered Verbal Communication	Reflection Journal 2
3/17/20-3/27/20	**SPRING BREAK—Relax ☺**		
3/31/20	**Communication (Cont')**	Chapter 6: Gendered Nonverbal Communication	
4/2/20	**Communication (Cont')**	Chapter 6 (Cont'): Nonverbal Communication	Research Essay
4/7/20	LGBT+ Sensitivity		
4/9/20	Transgender Sensitivity/Considerations in Education		
4/14/20	**Gendered Communication in Education**	Chapter 8: Gendered Education:	

		Communication in Schools (From Beginning to Gender Pressures from Peers)	
4/16/20	**Gendered Communication in Education (Cont')**	Chapter 8 (Cont'): From Gender Pressure from Peers through end of chapter	Reflection Journal 3
4/21/20	**Gendered Communication in Organizations**	Chapter 10: Gendered Organizational Communication (Beginning to Gendered Patterns in Organizations)	
4/23/20	**Gendered Communication in Organizations (Cont')**	Chapter 10 (Cont'): Gendered Patterns through end of chapter	
4/28/20	**Gender and Media**	Chapter 11: Gendered Media (Beginning to Gender and Social Media	
4/30/20	**Gender and Media (Cont')**	Chapter 11 (Cont'): Gender and Social Media through end of chapter	
5/5/20	**Gender and Relationships**	Chapter 9: Gendered Close Relationships (Beginning to Gendered Romantic Relationships	
5/7/20	**Gender and Relationships (Cont')**	Chapter 9 (Cont'): Gendered Romantic Relationships through the end of the chapter	Personal Narrative Final Paper Due
5/14/20	***NO CLASS—FINALS***		*Group Project Due*

Please remember to check Canvas and email regularly for updates and announcements.

Students are responsible for any withdrawal from the course. If a student does not attend class and does not withdraw, university policy dictates that a grade of "F" be given for the course.